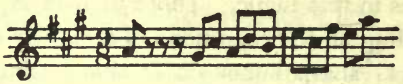
FUGUE 19

A MAJOR (THREE VOICES).

A fugue of such irregular construction that it might almost be termed a Caprice or Fantasia in fugal style. The limit of the subject is not clearly defined, but its later treatment suggests that it consists of the following:—



Exposition.—The subject is announced in the treble, and answered by the alto in stretto at one bar's distance. Although the subject does not modulate, and contains no conspicuous dominant, Bach has elected to give a **tonal** answer, according to an idiom whereby he always prefers to regard the leading-note as the third of the dominant, and answer it by the third of the tonic, unless it be an obvious auxiliary note; compare No. 23, also, to some extent, Nos. 18 (second note) and 24 (seventh note). After a few notes of codetta, the bass enters with the subject at the beginning of bar 4. The next two entries, namely in the bass again (but with the answer) at bar 6 and in the treble (with the subject) at bar 9 might be regarded as an irregular, partial counter-exposition, as they are still in the original keys.

Middle and Final Sections.—From this point onwards, it is only necessary to indicate the various entries of the subject. These are:—Bar 13, in F sharp minor, in the bass; bar 16 (irregular and incomplete) in the bass, modulating into E; bars 23 to 28 a group of entries in the original keys, the subject in the bass being given a tonal answer in the treble (varied at the end)

Ebenezer Prout: Analysis of J. S. Bach's Forty-Eight Fugues
Ed. Louis B. Prout. London: Edwin Ashdown, 1910. Printed pp. 44-45.
BWV 864. Complete original pages; adjoining commentary is retained.
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and a real answer in the alto (its first note an octave higher than would have been regular); bars 31 to 34, two entries of the subject in the key of D, alto and bass, both irregular, the latter modulating into B minor; bar 39, in F sharp minor in bass, the initial note and rests wanting; bar 42 (presumably the "final section") in A major in the alto, the first note altered, answered at bar 44 by the bass. From this point onwards the subject is absent, the passage forming a somewhat extended coda.

As a whole, the fugue is inferior in interest to most of the series.

FUGUE 20

A MAJOR (FOUR VOICES).

A long and elaborate fugue, interesting in its construction, but perhaps, not one of the most beautiful. The inversion of the subject is somewhat ungainly.

Exposition.—The subject is announced in the alto:—



The answer is **real**, and is given to the treble; there is no regular countersubject. After a bar of codetta (bar 7) the bass takes the subject, the answer in the tenor (bars 10 to 14) completing the exposition.

Middle Section.—The episodes are few and unimportant. A series of entries of the subject, by inverse movement, immediately follows the exposition. That in the alto (bar 17) is fragmentary, being succeeded by the tenor in stretto at half-a-bar's distance; on